

Assignment 3: Reflections and Lessons from the Internship

April Six, now Marketbridge (recently acquired) - Sarah Hippenmeyer

1. Provide a brief overview of the internship, the number of hours worked, what you did.

At my internship this summer, which I actually began in May, I worked part time (20 hours a week), and will continue working into the Fall quarter until November. At first I was mainly focused on completed operations and administrative tasks. These tasks included tracking our corporate credit card expenses, providing a mid-month and end-of-month credit card report, and opening new projects or “jobs” as we call them in Asana and our time tracking/billing system. I also was managing tasks like entering employee’s PTO into our Asana system for resourcing purposes, providing a graphic of everyone’s PTO every Monday, and managing everyone’s timesheets. As my internship progressed, I began working with our new business and client development team and helped them build out timelines and tasks for the design and development team for prospective clients. Some of the projects the new business team had me help with was creating client case studies of the work our marketing agency has done for clients. Additionally, the new business team has been focused on creating an interactive pitch site for prospective clients to browse what our work for them could look like. I have also been working alongside one of our client teams, AWS Thought Leadership, where I get to join weekly meetings with our account managers, the AWS client and several popular publications, like The Guardian, Business Insider, WIRED and The Washington Post. For this client, our agency works with publications to advertise AWS to other businesses and AWS often creates sponsored content for these publications. I’ve also gotten to work with our media team who is solely responsible for managing the analytics that are collected after our agency’s marketing work is published or released. They handle large reporting spreadsheets and are focused on the types of interaction the content brings in, from what locations and through which ways.

2. What were some of the new things that you learned during the internship?

During this internship I have learned a lot; it’s hard to say exactly what new things I’ve learned. I would say the most important thing I have learned is that B2B marketing is often a lot more versatile than B2C marketing. This is because B2B doesn’t always follow the standard calendar year product release cycle. Like many B2C companies, products and services follow a cycle year after year, in which most of the time, companies will prepare months in advance what they will release for each season. B2C is also primarily focused on price, branding and convenience. In B2B, this is a lot more versatile. B2B covers a range of ways businesses can interact, negotiate and create value with one another. The contracts are often worth millions and span several years, with terms that can be adjusted for scope, and volume. Deals can be structured as subscriptions, licensing, partnerships, or performance-based agreements, giving businesses more options to fit unique business situations. B2B solutions often involve integrating into another company’s operations.

3. What were some of the things that surprised you?

What most surprised me at this internship was that although it is fully remote, the team is incredibly close with one another, several of them knowing each other beyond the work space. This allows for a lot more

intimate and genuine interactions and conversations. It has also made me feel more comfortable talking to my managers and other team members.

4. How will you use the learnings from this internship to position yourself for a job interview? i.e. what have you learned to do well due to your experience.

I think I have certainly improved my professionalism and learned how to ask insightful questions. I have also found ways to better learn and work through difficult situations independently before asking for help. I think these are all strengths that I can take with me into my next job interview, being able to better converse, ask questions and also market myself. I also believe that all the skills I have gained in project management I can market myself as a more ideal candidate.

5. Are there any specific insights or observations related to the EMPAC model that you learned during your internship?

During my internship at April Six, I was able to see the EMPAC model applied in real client work. On the messaging side, I saw how even slight tweaks in wording or positioning can change how a campaign resonates with different decision-makers. From a process perspective, being involved in job requests and project resourcing showed me how much structure is needed behind the scenes to deliver creative work on time. Looking at the audience, I noticed how campaigns are tailored differently for technical buyers versus executive decision makers, especially in B2B tech. And on the channel side, I saw firsthand how teams decide which mix (events, digital, social, paid media) makes the most impact for a client's objectives. Overall, the EMPAC framework gave me a helpful way to connect what I was doing day-to-day to the bigger picture of how an integrated campaign comes together.